

ATTRACTION: Sheetla Mandir

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

Shitala Devi Temple, Agam Kuan

LOCATION:

Agam Kuan Guljarbagh, Patna

DISTRICT / REGION:

Patna

CATEGORY:

Religious Site / Archaeological Site

OVERVIEW:

Agam Kuan is an ancient well and archaeological site in Patna, dating back to the period of Mauryan emperor Ashoka. Circular in shape, the well is lined with brick in the upper 13 metres (43 ft) and contains wooden rings in the remaining 19 metres (62 ft). Adjacent to it is the Shitala Devi temple, where the folk deity statue of Shitala Devi is located. Inside this temple, the pindas of the Saptamatikas (the seven mother goddesses) are worshipped. The temple is widely revered for its belief in curing smallpox and chicken pox.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

The site encompasses both the historical Agam Kuan well and the revered Sheetla Mandir. The ancient well, Agam Kuan, is circular and dates back to the Mauryan period under Emperor Ashoka. It measures 13 metres lined with brick and an additional 19 metres with wooden rings. The Shitala Devi temple houses the statue of Shitala Devi and the pindas of the Saptamatikas. It holds strong religious significance for locals.

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

Agam Kuan is a significant archaeological feature from the reign of Emperor Ashoka. The attached Shitala Devi temple is deeply culturally significant as a center of faith and traditional healing.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

The temple is widely revered for its belief in curing smallpox and chicken pox. Devotees visit the temple to seek the blessings of Shitala Devi for health and recovery from these illnesses. Inside the temple, the Saptamatikas (the seven mother goddesses) are worshipped.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- Ancient Agam Kuan well dating back to Mauryan emperor Ashoka.
- Unique well structure with brick lining and wooden rings.
- Shitala Devi temple housing the folk deity statue.
- Worship of the Saptamatikas (seven mother goddesses).
- Revered for its traditional belief in curing smallpox and chicken pox.

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit: October to March

Opening Hours: 04:00 AM - 08:00 PM

Entry Fee: Not Mentioned

Duration Recommended: Not Mentioned

Photography: Videography & Photography Allowed

Accessibility Information: Not Mentioned

FACILITIES:

Parking, Restaurants, Drinking Water, Videography & Photography Allowed, Souvenir Shop

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport: Patna Airport

Distance From Airport: 14 Kms

Nearest Railway Station: Gulzarbagh

Distance From Railway Station: 02 Kms

Nearest Bus Stand: Bairiya

Distance From Bus Stand: 05 Kms

Road Connectivity: Not Mentioned

Nearest Tourist Information Centre: Rajendra Nagar Railway Station (05 Kms)

Nearest Police Station: Agamkuan (05 Kms), Ph : 0612-2350184

Nearest Medical Facility: PHC, Rajendra Nagar, Ph : 0612-2670044; NMCH, Patna, Ph : 0612-2631159

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

- Golghar (08 Kms)
- Patna Museum (07 Kms)
- Bihar Museum (08 Kms)
- Gandhi Museum (08 Kms)
- Iskon Temple (07 Kms)
- Sabhyata dwar (08 Kms)
- Khuda Baksh Libarary (11 Kms)

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Devotees participate in traditional prayers focused on healing and health, particularly related to the deity Shitala Devi.

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Souvenir shop is available at the site.

ACCOMMODATION:

- Amit Hotel
- Hotel Republic
- Hotel Windsor
- Hotel Chanakya
- Hotel Gargee

HOTELS:

- Amit Hotel, Mob : 9931040050
- Hotel Republic, Mob : 9334318652
- Hotel Windsor, Mob : 9934623620
- Hotel Chanakya, Mob : 9410175502
- Hotel Gargee, Mob : 6122500535

LOCAL GUIDES:

- Ramesh Kumar, Mob : 9308369046
- Manoj Kumar, Mob : 7549030455

- Mohan Kumar, Mob : 9905456664
- Sima Sharma, Mob : 9308019299
- Vinod Kumar, Mob : 7870641396/919993391

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

- Kumar Taxi - 9504222883
- Dream Vition - 8240420065
- Shasavan Taxi Service - 9835242220
- Kripaji Taxi - 8987343306

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- The Agam Kuan well is 32 meters deep (13m brick-lined + 19m wooden rings).
- The well dates back to Emperor Ashoka's era.
- The temple is famous for traditional beliefs in curing smallpox.

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

Sheetla Mandir and Agam Kuan form a significant historical and religious site in Guljarbagh, Patna. Agam Kuan is an ancient circular well from Emperor Ashoka's period, featuring unique brick and wooden ring linings. The adjacent Shitala Devi temple houses the deity Shitala Devi and the Saptamatrikas, and is widely revered for the belief that it cures smallpox and chicken pox. The site is best visited between October and March from 04:00 AM to 08:00 PM. It offers parking, drinking water, restaurants, and a souvenir shop. It is conveniently located 2 Kms from Gulzarbagh Railway Station.

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What is this attraction known for?

A: It is known for the ancient Agam Kuan well from Ashoka's period and the Shitala Devi temple, revered for curing smallpox and chicken pox.

Q: Where is it located?

A: It is located at Agam Kuan Guljarbagh, Patna.

Q: What are the nearby attractions?

A: Nearby attractions include Patna Museum (7 Kms), Golghar (8 Kms), and Bihar Museum (8 Kms).

Q: How can visitors reach it?

A: It can be reached easily as it is just 2 Kms from Gulzarbagh Railway Station and 14 Kms from Patna Airport.

Q: What facilities are available?

A: Facilities include parking, restaurants, drinking water, a souvenir shop, and permitted videography and photography.

KEYWORDS:

Sheetla Mandir, Agam Kuan, Shitala Devi, Saptamatrikas, Emperor Ashoka, Patna historical well, smallpox cure temple, Bihar religious sites.